

Rep. Tom Emmer on Squawk Box

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****JOE:**

** House Majority Whip, Tom Emmer, who is always smiling and it's early and you do this for a living and you're still smiling and I just ask you about that. It is, you must enjoy it, but you must enjoy going into battle every day, right?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** People are interesting animals, Joe. Every day is a day of learning something new about somebody and what they will do, what they won't do, how they feel. It's every day is different.

****JOE:**

** I was kidding, I said both sides think they're right when they say the lunatics are running the asylum.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, and sometimes maybe you should look in the mirror, right? Maybe both sides should look in the mirror and both sides maybe hit some. Oh no, I'm going to blame just one side.

****JOE:**

** How much harder is your job though as whip to try and get people to vote in line with the prerogatives of the party at this point?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well look, I think one of the misunderstood things out there is that somehow because you're a Republican or you're a Democrat, you suddenly wear a Jersey and that's the way you're going to vote. We only have two rules for our members. The first rule is you take care of the people at home first. There's nobody in Washington DC that cast a vote for you, so you take care of those people. You're their voice. Second, you take care of yourself. If you can do those two things, then we can help you be part of a team. But the way you do that is communication and trust. They trust us to take personal stuff. We communicate to them why and why it will help them and their constituents.

****JOE:**

** But Joe alluded to this earlier, is it tougher to do because of some animus that may be there because the president has campaigned against some sitting Republicans recently? It looked like he was firmly in control of his party. He wants to oust someone, Massey's gone. He wants to oust someone, Cassidy's gone. But then when push comes to shove, it looks like some people, maybe Senator Thune was rubbed the wrong way. Senator McConnell at this point has maybe got some other stuff that, you know, if it kills us, we know where he's going to go. Votes weren't there at this point, right?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Votes weren't there. You're talking about the Senate. That's what I mean. We get the stuff done over in the House. The Senate, I think 77 million people are frustrated with the Senate's inability to get its work done and to pass the president's agenda that they voted for. Everybody's frustrated with that. But when you talk about the president, I mean, this just should prove to everybody that these nonsense polls that are out there, that are telling us how the president has never had a lower approval rating, all the other stuff. What last week showed everybody once again is Donald Trump is the leader of the Republican Party. Donald Trump still holds the strength that he has held throughout his years now of growth in this position. There's never been anybody like him. There's not going to be anybody like him anytime soon in the future. That is how he rolls. I've seen it.

****JOE:**

** Democrats, I've been hearing it in the first term, this term. When are Republicans going to stand up to some of this stuff is what they're always saying. Now, I'm just this. I'm just, you know, I got a jacket on, so I'm going to ask these questions. The slush fund or whatever you want to call it, the move to go back on the audits and permanently put those to bed. Is that a bridge too far for some Republicans that might have been uncomfortable with other things? Is that are we finally hitting a point where some people are saying enough or let's first put it in context.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** This is a Senate that tells us regularly they don't have the votes. They don't have the votes for the Save America Act, but more than 70 percent of Americans agree with you're bringing up a something that was added, as I understand it, to the funding bill. We call it the funding bill because we had to do it with 50 plus one because Democrats apparently hate our law enforcement and weren't willing to fund CBP in the ice. Now they've added this fund. I would like to hear from Todd Blanch. I understand that they started to hear from him yesterday as to exactly what this is. Great. Let's find out what it is before everybody crucifies. And I think people over there look for excuses every day to say no instead of enacting the the agenda. 77 million Democrats have been impeached twice already. It has been, you know, you cry wolf so many times that maybe you hear less of you're inured to hearing so many things. You don't take it seriously.

****JOE:**

** But maybe having your own personal lawyer at this point become a G, the A.G. is the only person that could have gotten rid of these audits. Right. And it was his personal lawyer. It just looks it just looks smells bad. But I have said the president is so upset with the way he's been treated in terms of lawfare that if he can do something, he does it because he can at this point.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Joe, I think it's unfair to say it's just the president who's upset. Americans are upset. They don't want to see their government be used against anyone, Donald Trump or anybody else. And by the way, it was so egregious what they did to Donald Trump and his family. It's one of the reasons that he's back in the office. America wants this cleaned up. And Donald Trump is going to make sure it is.

****JOE:**

** Do you think eventually this fund there will be this retribution fund will will be. You are playing the role. Well, with. Thank you. OK, let's call it. What did you call it? You had a better a better trip.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** I have. It's we're going to find out what it is. I mean, I'm not going to give it a term. I want to know what it is, if it's going to be reimbursements to people who have been wrongfully prosecuted and attacked by the federal government. Let's find out what it is first before everybody. I think the questions I think the questions are, how would it be distributed and how would that go about? There should be lots of questions. And I think those are the questions that should be asked, as opposed to our Senate. We don't have the votes for this. And we're looking for a reason to say no yet again, figure out how to get your job done so that we can move this thing forward for the American Senate were to pass it.

****JOE:**

** Do you think that the House would pass it immediately?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** We're going to have our challenges as soon as they put a final product together. Then we have to go to work right now. All we know is that we, because of the work that we did in the House two weeks ago to fund CBP and to fund Homeland Security in general, we now don't have a crisis until at least the first week of June. The Senate has to get its work done. Republicans and Democrats. And by the way, some would argue there are no Republicans and there are no Democrats. There are only senators. So figure out how to fix this so that we can move it forward in the House.

****JOE:**

** Andrew, he called me you. Do you want to, do you want to be, are you going to be me or are you going to be you I'll be me.

****ANDREW:**

** Hey Tom, just so I understand you. So we're all clear. You support the settlement that the president made with, some people would say he made with himself. Others would say it was with the AG. You're supportive of that. You feel like that's, that was, it's totally on the up and up. And then the secondary part, of course, can you hear me?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** I can hear you, but you couldn't. You should say no. No, I can hear you. I, again, as Rebecca and I were just talking about, let's see what it is when it comes over to the House. The Senate's got to get their work done, Andrew, and you're asking me to pass judgment on something that they haven't even finalized.

****ANDREW:**

** No, no, no. The settlement unto itself. The settlement unto itself. Putting, putting aside, no, I'm not talking about the justice fund. I'm just saying the settlement that was made between the president and the administration. I mean, that's what's happened here. Do you, do you look at that and say, that's totally fine? You support, you support how that was done?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, I wasn't in the room, so I don't know what the details are, but I can tell you this, Donald Trump, no one knows what weaponization of government against him and his family better than Donald Trump. He was absolutely raked by these people for years, and the American public knows it, Andrew. I suspect that whatever agreement was made, it's fair on both sides of the agreement. I wasn't in the room, so I don't pass judgment.

****ANDREW:**

** You failed, Andrew. You failed to be me. All right? You're being you and I'm being you, and it's, I think I apologize. Becky's in the middle.

****JOE:**

** No. Thank you very much. Thank you both. Appreciate it. Great to be with you on your field trip.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Yep. Thank you. That's right.

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